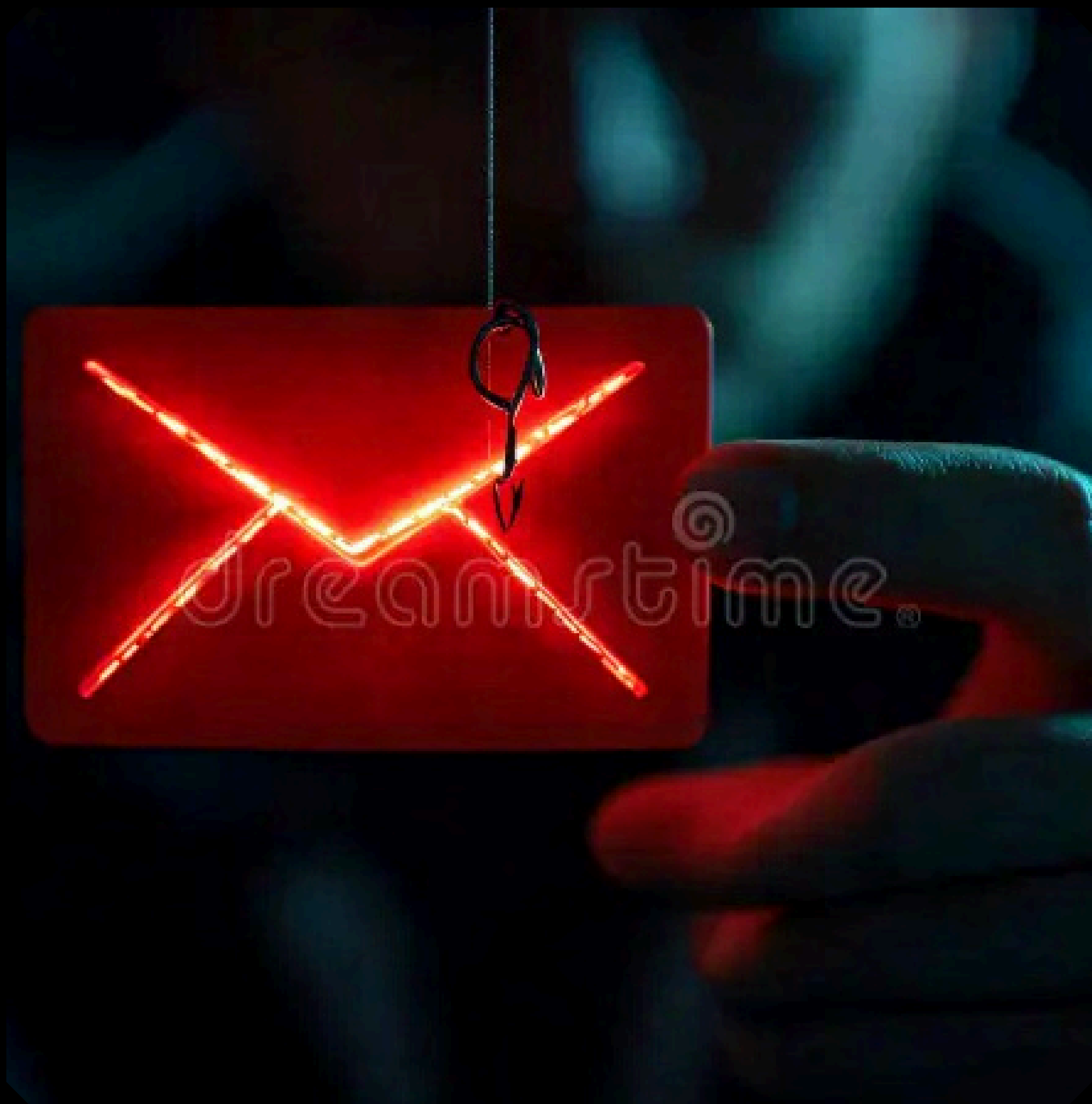


NOZIMANGA

PHISHING AWARENESS PRESENTATION





OVERVIEW

RIISING PHISHING ATTACKS

Phishing attacks remain one of the most dominant and dangerous attack vectors used by cybercriminals to target both individuals and organizations worldwide. The reason phishing continues to dominate the cybersecurity threat landscape is because of its simplicity, scalability and high success rate. Because phishing targets the human element rather than just technical systems, it remains one of the most effective entry points for cyberattack and continues to pose a significant threat in today's increasingly digital world.



DEFINITION OF PHISHING

CONCEPT AND CORE PURPOSE

Phishing is a type of cyberattack in which attackers impersonate trusted individuals, organizations, or service to deceive victims into revealing sensitive information, clicking malicious links, downloading harmful attachments, or granting unauthorized access to systems and accounts.

These attacks are designed to manipulate human emotions such as fear, urgency, curiosity, or trust in order to trick victims into taking actions that compromise their security, as cybercriminals often disguise themselves as legitimate entities to make their messages appear authentic and convincing.

An illustration of a smartphone displaying a login form with fields for Username and Password, a Login button, and a red warning sign. A credit card and a SIM card are also shown near the phone. The background is dark red with a grid pattern. Below the illustration, the text "shutterstock.com · 2754080625" is visible in a small, white font.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE PHISHING AND FAKE WEBSITES

FOR EMAILS:

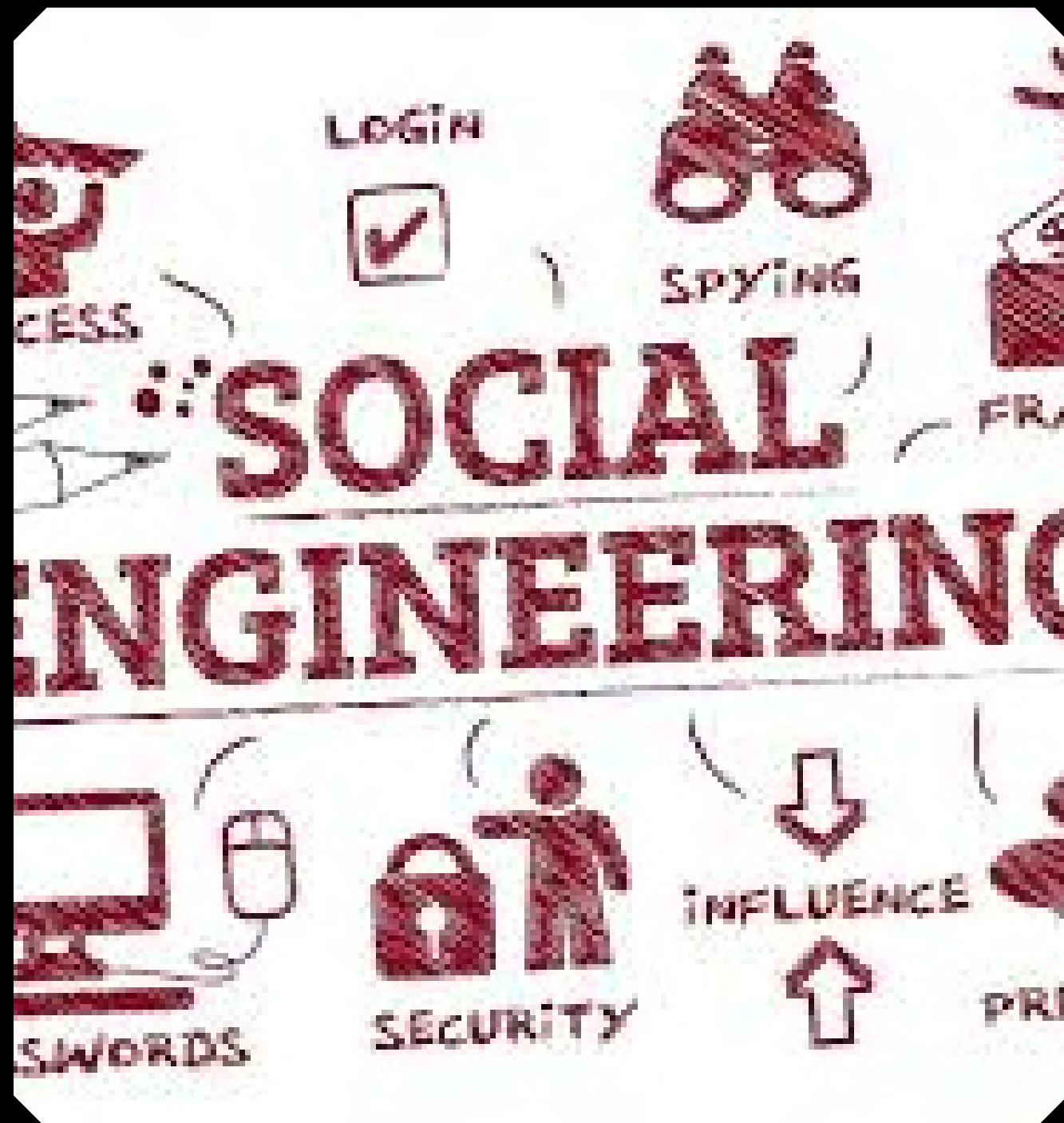
- **Suspicious Sender Address:** The email may look similar to a real company but contains small changes or misspellings.
- **Urgent or Threatening Language:** Attackers often create panic to senders so that the manipulation is successful into persuading them to click on links.
- **Requests for sensitive information:** Legitimate organizations rarely ask for passwords and OTPs.

FOR FAKE WEBSITES:

- **Check the Website URL Carefully:** Fake websites often use misspellings, extra characters, different domain endings.
- **Poor Website Design or Functionality:** Fake websites may contain broken images, strange layouts
- **Pop Ups and Fake Security Warnings:** Fake websites display alarming pop-ups claiming you have won a prize.



SOCIAL ENGINEERING



DEFINITION

Social Engineering is a manipulation technique used by cybercriminals to deceive individuals into revealing confidential information, granting unauthorized access, or performing actions that compromise security. Instead of attacking computer systems directly, social engineering targets human behaviour, emotions, and trust to achieve malicious objectives.

Social engineering attacks can occur through emails, phone calls, text messages, social media platforms, or face-to-face interactions. It is considered one of the most dangerous cybersecurity threats because even highly secure systems can be compromised if attackers successfully manipulate people into bypassing security measures.



SOCIAL ENGINEERING VECTORS USED BY ATTACKERS

Social Engineering attacks use different methods, known as vectors, to manipulate people into revealing sensitive information or performing harmful actions. Cyberattackers use these techniques because targeting human behaviour is often easier and more effective than attacking technical systems directly. The attacker vectors include:

- Phishing
- Spear Phishing
- Whaling
- Vishing (Voice Phishing)
- Smishing (SMS Phishing)
- Baiting



DIFFERENT STAGES OF SOCIAL ENGINEERING

TIPS TO AVOID FALLING VICTIM



DO NOT SHARE SENSITIVE INFORMATION

Never share passwords, verification codes (OTPs), banking information, personal identification details. Legitimate organizations rarely request sensitive information through email, phone calls or messages.



VERIFY BEFORE TRUSTING

Always confirm the identity of anyone requesting sensitive information, money, passwords, or account access.



USE STRONG AND UNIQUE PASSWORDS

Create passwords that are long and complex. Combine letters, numbers, and symbols, and are different for every account. Consider using a Password manager for secure storage.



ENABLE MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION

Multi-Factor Authentication adds an extra layer of security by requiring additional verification beyond just a password. Even if attackers steal a password, MFA can help prevent unauthorized access.



KEEP SOFTWARE AND DEVICES UPDATED

Install updates regularly for operating systems, browsers, antivirus software, applications. Updates often include security patches that fix vulnerabilities.



PROTECTION AND ASSURANCE

So the next time you think of clicking on that suspicious website/email, ask yourself these questions:

- Is the link/email address name spelled correctly?
- Why am I getting an email which contains a code says that I must verify?
- Why would I win R100 000 or got a job offer suddenly?

ENGAGEMENT TIPS



CONCLUSION

CLOSING THOUGHTS AND ACTION

As technology continues to advance, cybercriminals are becoming increasingly sophisticated in the methods they use to deceive people.

Therefore, individuals and organizations must remain vigilant, informed, and proactive in maintaining cybersecurity awareness and implementing effective security measures. Ultimately, cybersecurity is not only about protecting systems and networks, but also about protecting people from manipulation and deception.

